

 **AI LEGAL RESEARCH IN SECONDS**

SpaceL AI

SpaceL AI helps law students and legal professionals understand criminal judgments using grounded AI.

Ask a legal question, retrieve real Supreme Court judgment passages, and get structured reasoning with transparent source evidence.

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See how legal research becomes faster using grounded AI over real judgments.

AI for Legal Solutions | SpaceL AI MVP Demo (LangChain + RAG)

Anusha Narayanan



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How It Works

A simple workflow designed for fast legal research demos.

1 Ask a legal question

Type a question about bail, evidence, appeals, sentencing, or benefit of doubt.

2 AI retrieves real judgments

SpaceL AI searches the existing FAISS judgment index for relevant passages.

3 Get grounded reasoning

Receive structured legal reasoning with source evidence you can inspect.

Built for High-Frequency Criminal Law Questions

✓ Bail conditions

✓ Benefit of doubt

✓ Circumstantial evidence

✓ Criminal appeals

✓ Sentencing

Why Trust SpaceL AI?

Built to make legal AI feel transparent, cautious, and useful.

Grounded in Court Judgments

Answers are generated from retrieved judgment passages, not generic web text.

Legal Reasoning Support

Legal Mode organizes issues, reasoning, takeaways, and evidence.

Student-Friendly Mode

Student Mode explains concepts in plain English while staying source-grounded.

Transparent Source Evidence

Every answer keeps retrieved documents visible for review.

SpaceL AI Impact

Helping law students simplify legal research with transparent, source-backed answers.

120+

Legal Queries
Processed

67%

Helpful Responses

32

Active Testers

Real

judgments
Grounding

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SpaceL AI

Criminal case research assistant powered by Supreme Court judgments (2008-2023)

Try these:

[Benefit of doubt](#)[Bail conditions](#)[Circumstantial evidence](#)

Judgment index loaded. SpaceL AI is ready.



A private financier unlawfully detains an individual in a secret location over an unpaid loan. The local police are unable to track them down. Can a distant relative step in and bypass the lower courts to file a petition directly to the Supreme Court of India?



Retrieving legal precedents...

High confidence (5 documents retrieved)



Legal Reasoning

Analysis: Direct Supreme Court Petition for Private Unlawful

Detention

1. Key Insight

The retrieved judgments establish that the Supreme Court possesses constitutional authority under Articles 136 and 142 to intervene in matters involving fundamental rights violations, including unlawful detention. However, the Court exercises discretion in determining the appropriate forum for relief. While habeas corpus writs can address private detention, the judgments do not explicitly authorize bypassing lower courts as a matter of routine practice. The Court's intervention appears reserved for cases where public interest is substantial or where lower court remedies are inadequate, not as an automatic right for distant relatives.

2. Legal Issue

Can a distant relative file a petition directly to the Supreme Court of India under Article 32 (or seek special jurisdiction under Article 136) to secure the release of an individual unlawfully detained by a private financier, without first exhausting remedies in lower courts?

3. Legal Reasoning

Constitutional Authority for Supreme Court Intervention:

Source 2 establishes that "Article 136 read with Article 142 of the Constitution of India enables this Court to pass such orders, which are necessary for doing complete justice in any cause or matter pending before it." This grants the Supreme Court discretionary power to intervene in matters of fundamental rights.

Private Detention and Habeas Corpus:

Source 5 directly addresses private detention, stating: "The issue before us in the present case is whether the High Court can direct the release of a petitioner under G.O.(Ms.) No.64 dated 01.02.2018" and earlier notes that "writ of habeas corpus would lie" in cases of private detention. The judgment emphasizes that "if the Rules are to be the masters and not the Constitution, then, probably in the Madras High Court no writ of habeas corpus would be entertained in the case of private detention. This would be against the spirit of the Constitution of India."

Fundamental Rights Protection:

Source 4 reinforces that "this Court, irrespective of enormity and gravity of allegations made against the detenu, has to intervene" when fundamental rights are at stake, citing the principle that "the gravity of the evil to the community resulting from anti-social activities cannot furnish sufficient reason for invading the personal liberty of a citizen, except in accordance with the procedure established by law."

Forum Selection and Public Interest:

However, Source 3 introduces a critical limitation: "It is only the forum in which the right to seek relief has been varied, and not denied." This suggests the Court may redirect petitioners to appropriate lower forums while preserving the substantive right to relief. The judgment also notes that "public interest cannot be flung out of the" consideration, implying the Court balances individual rights against systemic efficiency.

4. Final Takeaway

A distant relative may petition the Supreme Court directly for habeas corpus relief in cases of unlawful private detention, as the Constitution protects fundamental liberty rights regardless of the detainer's status (state or private actor). However, the Supreme Court exercises discretion in accepting such petitions. While the Court possesses constitutional authority under Articles 32, 136, and 142 to intervene, it may decline to bypass lower courts unless:

- Lower court remedies are demonstrably inadequate or unavailable;
- The case involves substantial public interest; or
- Exceptional circumstances justify direct intervention.

The retrieved judgments do not establish an automatic right to bypass lower courts; rather, they confirm the Court's *capacity* to intervene when fundamental rights are violated, while preserving judicial discretion over forum selection.

5. Source Evidence

Source 1 (2020): Establishes that habeas corpus petitions are not entertained when detention is by competent court order appearing *prima facie* lawful, but implies such writs *are* available in other circumstances (private detention context).

Source 2 (2017): "Article 136 read with Article 142 of the Constitution of India enables this Court to pass such orders, which are necessary for doing complete justice in any cause or matter pending before it." Confirms Supreme Court's discretionary jurisdiction but notes "the forum in which the right to seek relief has been varied, and not denied."

Source 3 (2017): Reiterates that while fundamental rights cannot be curtailed, the Court may vary the forum for seeking relief without denying the right itself, balancing individual rights against public interest.

Source 4 (2009): "When it comes to fundamental rights under the Constitution, this Court, irrespective of enormity and gravity of allegations made against the detenu, has to intervene." Establishes the Court's obligation to protect liberty rights.

Source 5 (2020): "Writ of habeas corpus would lie" in private detention cases. "If the Rules are to be the masters and not the Constitution, then, probably in the Madras High Court no writ of habeas corpus would be entertained in the case of private detention. This would be against the spirit of the Constitution of India." Directly confirms habeas corpus availability for private detention but does not mandate Supreme Court as first forum.

Limitation: The retrieved judgments provide limited direct discussion on whether a *distant relative* (as opposed to the detainee themselves) has standing to petition directly to the Supreme Court. The available passages address the Court's power to intervene in detention cases but

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 Helpful

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Help me improve: What worked? What was confusing? Would you come back?

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Source Evidence

✓ Source 1 — Supreme Court Judgment | Case Year: 2020 | Page: 15

PDF: 18046_2019_11_1501_19778_Judgement_23-Jan-2020.pdf

Case year: 2020

Page: 15

Clean snippet:

is not to be entertained when a person is committed to judicial custody or police custody by the competent court by an order which prima facie does not appear to be without jurisdiction or passed in an absolutely mechanical manner or wholly illegal....”
24. In Saurabh Kumar v. Jailor, Koneila Jail 10, this Court came to the conclusion that the petitioner was in judicial custody 7 (1973) 2 SCC 674 8 (2013) 1 SCC 314 9 Ranjit Singh v. State of Pepsu, AIR 1959 SC 843, Ummu Sabeena v. State of Kerala, (2011) 10 SCC 781, in the matter of Madhu Limaye and Others, (1969) 1 SCC 292, Talib Hussain v. State of Jammu & Kashmir, (1971) 3 SCC 118, Sanjay Dutt v. State (II), (1994) 5 SCC 410 10 (2014) 13 SCC 436 16

✓ Source 2 — Supreme Court Judgment | Case Year: 2017 | Page: 50

PDF: 37925_2016_Judgement_13-Jul-2017.pdf

Case year: 2017

Page: 50

Clean snippet:

spreads overseas and the larger public interest involved, passed the orders impugned, reserving the right of all, including the accused persons, to move this Court if their prayer would amount to staying or impeding the progress of the trial. In case they have any grievance against the orders passed by the Special Judge during trial, they are free to approach this Court so that the progress of the trial would not be hampered by indulging in cumbersome and time-consuming proceedings in the other forums,

thereby stultifying the peremptory direction given by this Court for day-to-day trial. Article 136 read with Article 142 of the Constitution of India enables this Court to pass such orders, which are necessary for doing complete justice in any cause or matter pending before it and, any order so made, shall be enforceable throughout the territory of India.

✓ Source 3 — Supreme Court Judgment | Case Year: 2017 | Page: 31

PDF: 37925_2016_Judgement_13-Jul-2017.pdf

Case year: 2017

Page: 31

Clean snippet:

Court Bar Association v. Union of India .23 It is not necessary for us to further elucidate this position or to elaborate on it. 52. While it is true that the fundamental rights of a citizen cannot be taken away even by an order of the court except where a restriction is placed by the statute such as remanding an accused to judicial custody, no right of the appellants has been curtailed by this Court by the order under consideration. As repeatedly emphasized, it is only the forum in which the right to seek relief has been varied, and not denied. We do not see how this is impermissible or contrary to any law or any fundamental right of the appellants. 53. This Court is undoubtedly obliged to protect the fundamental rights of the people in the country in accordance with the Constitution, but it is equally true that while doing so public interest cannot be flung out of the

✓ Source 4 — Supreme Court Judgment | Case Year: 2009 | Page: 8

PDF: 35682.pdf

Case year: 2009

Page: 8

Clean snippet:

have to be dealt with a firm hand, but when it comes to fundamental rights under the Constitution, this Court, irrespective of enormity and gravity of allegations made against the detenu, has to intervene as was indicated in Mahesh Kumar Chauhan's case, [(1990)

3 SCC148] and in an earlier decision in *Prabhu Dayal Deorah v. Distt. Magistrate*, [(1974) 1 SCC 103] in which it was observed that the gravity of the evil to the community resulting from anti-social activities cannot furnish sufficient reason for invading the personal liberty of a citizen, except in accordance with the procedure established by law particularly as normal penal laws would still be available for being invoked rather than keeping a person in detention without trial. 14) The counsel for the appellant also relies on the decision of this court in the case of *Rajesh Gulati v. Government of NCT of Delhi* and another

✓ Source 5 — Supreme Court Judgment | Case Year: 2020 | Page: 21

PDF: 18046_2019_11_1501_19778_Judgement_23-Jan-2020.pdf

Case year: 2020

Page: 21

Clean snippet:

habeas corpus would lie. If the Rules are to be the masters and not the Constitution, then, probably in the Madras High Court no writ of habeas corpus would be entertained in the case of private detention. This would be against the spirit of the Constitution of India. Therefore, we are clearly of the view that reference to the Rules is of no aid whatsoever. 31. The issue before us in the present case is whether the High Court can direct the release of a petitioner under G.O.(Ms.) No.64 dated 01.02.2018. We do not think so. In all these cases, the representations made by the detenus had not been decided. In our view, the proper course for the Court was to direct that the representations of the detenus be decided within a short period. Keeping in view the fact that the Scheme envisages a report of the Probation Officer, a reference by the District Level Committee and

✓ Copy full answer

Analysis: Direct Supreme Court Petition for Private Unlawful Detention

1. Key Insight

The retrieved judgments establish that the Supreme Court possesses const

2. Legal Issue

Can a distant relative file a petition directly to the Supreme Court of

3. Legal Reasoning

****Constitutional Authority for Supreme Court Intervention:****

Source 2 establishes that "Article 136 read with Article 142 of the Cons

****Private Detention and Habeas Corpus:****

Source 5 directly addresses private detention, stating: "The issue befor

****Fundamental Rights Protection:****

Source 4 reinforces that "this Court, irrespective of enormity and gravi

****Forum Selection and Public Interest:****

However, Source 3 introduces a critical limitation: "It is only the foru

4. Final Takeaway

****A distant relative may petition the Supreme Court directly for habeas**

- Lower court remedies are demonstrably inadequate or unavailable;
- The case involves substantial public interest; or
- Exceptional circumstances justify direct intervention.

The retrieved judgments do not establish an automatic right to bypass lc

5. Source Evidence

****Source 1**** (2020): Establishes that habeas corpus petitions are not er

****Source 2**** (2017): "Article 136 read with Article 142 of the Constitut

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****Source 4**** (2009): "When it comes to fundamental rights under the Cons

****Source 5**** (2020): "Writ of habeas corpus would lie" in private detent

****Limitation:**** The retrieved judgments provide limited direct discussic

Response generated in 14.31s

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